



AI-Powered IDEs: The 2025 Landscape

The AI-assisted development tooling market has matured rapidly. Today's options range from full-stack AI IDEs with autonomous agents to lightweight extensions that slot into your existing workflow. This guide breaks down the four most prominent players — **Cursor**, **Windsurf**, **Antigravity**, and **GitHub Copilot** — so engineering teams can make informed decisions about where to invest.

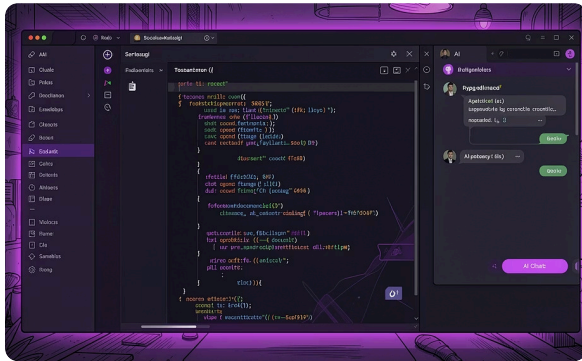
DEVELOPER TOOLS

AI CODING

IDE COMPARISON

Cursor & Windsurf: The Agent-First IDEs

Both Cursor and Windsurf represent the new generation of AI-native IDEs — not just autocomplete on steroids, but environments where AI agents understand your entire codebase and act with meaningful autonomy.



Cursor

Widely considered the best overall for deep codebase context. Cursor offers a refined UI and a distinctive "vibe coding" experience — developers describe it as fluid, almost conversational. Its agent can navigate large repositories, understand architectural patterns, and suggest changes across files with impressive coherence.

- Best-in-class codebase awareness
- Polished, intuitive UI
- Strong "vibe coding" workflow



Windsurf

Known for its "Cascade" agent, Windsurf delivers high-speed, autonomous coding with excellent memory for complex, multi-file projects. Where Cursor feels conversational, Windsurf feels like a tireless engineer — it remembers context across sessions and executes multi-step refactors with minimal hand-holding.

- Cascade agent for autonomous workflows
- Excellent long-term memory
- Optimised for complex, multi-file projects

Antigravity & GitHub Copilot: Planning-First vs. Integration-First

The other two contenders take fundamentally different philosophies — one prioritises deliberate planning before a single line of code is written, while the other respects your existing setup and enhances it with enterprise-grade AI.

Antigravity

A newer **agent-first platform** that focuses on "one-shotting" tasks. Before writing any code, Antigravity generates detailed planning documents — `tasks.md`, `plan.md` — that map out the full scope of work. This deliberate approach reduces hallucination and keeps complex refactors on track.

- Structured planning before execution
- Agent-first architecture
- Ideal for well-scoped, complex tasks

GitHub Copilot

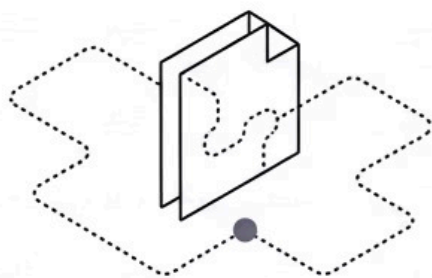
Best for developers who prefer to stay in their existing VS Code or IDE setup. Copilot doesn't require switching tools — it integrates natively with the editor you already use. With top-tier security, compliance features, and deep GitHub integration, it's the safest choice for enterprise teams.

- Zero workflow disruption
- Top-tier security and compliance
- Native GitHub and VS Code integration

Which One Should Your Team Choose?

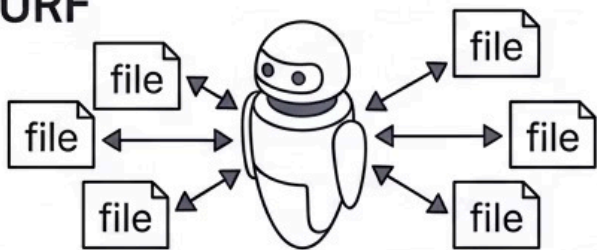
The right tool depends on your team's priorities — whether that's raw AI capability, workflow compatibility, or enterprise security. Here's a quick decision framework.

CURSOR



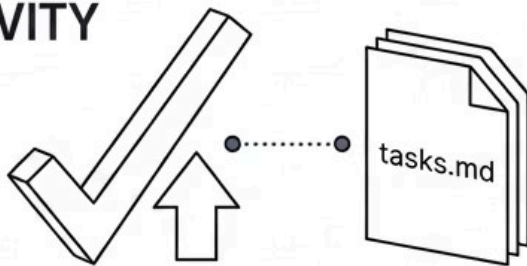
**Deep Codebase Context.
Best Overall. "Vibe Coding".**

WINDSURF



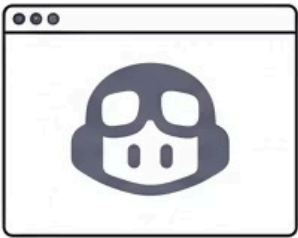
**Autonomous Cascade Agent.
Multi-File Memory & Speed.**

ANTIGRAVITY



**Planning-First. One-Shot
Tasks. uses "tasks.md" docs.**

GITHUB COPILOT



**VS Code Native. Existing IDE
Integration. Enterprise Security.**



Best Overall Experience

Cursor — if you want the most polished, context-aware AI coding experience available today.



Best for Autonomous Agents

Windsurf — if your team needs an AI that remembers, plans, and executes multi-file changes independently.



Best for Structured Planning

Antigravity — if your projects benefit from explicit planning documents before any code is written.



Best for Enterprise Teams

GitHub Copilot — if staying in your current IDE with enterprise-grade security is non-negotiable.